

This short text, found as Toh 779 in the Kangyur, belongs to the tantric ritual

Toh 779 · Derge Kangyur

This short text, found as Toh 779 in the Kangyur, belongs to the tantric ritual literature associated with dhāraṇī and mantra practice, though no distinct Sanskrit or Tibetan title is given beyond its opening homage to the Three Jewels. It presents a mantra to be recited before a representation of the Three Jewels, accompanied by prostrations, and explains the extraordinary merit generated by this practice—equating repeated recitation and prostration with the accumulated benefit of hearing, contemplating, and meditating upon the entire tripiṭaka. The text further promises that sustained practice, performed three times daily, can lead within a single lifetime to attainment of the meditative absorption associated with the path of seeing, while also offering protection from harm by humans, non-humans, and elemental spirits until that realization is achieved. As a practical ritual manual combining mantra, devotional gesture, and doctrinal assurance, it exemplifies the genre of merit-generating liturgical texts preserved in the Kangyur for lay and monastic use alike.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Before a support representing the Three Jewels, recite this mantra once each time, and perform one prostration with full-length bow. If three such prostrations are performed, this becomes equal in merit to hearing, contemplating, and meditating upon the three baskets (tripiṭaka). If three prostrations are done three times each day, then within this very life one will attain the meditative absorption of the wisdom of the path of seeing. Until that is attained, humans, non-humans, and elemental spirits...

Translator's Notes

- The passage is a fragment, ending mid-sentence ("elemental spirits and..."); the continuation is not included in the source text provided. "Elemental spirits" renders རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ (Skt. bhūta), a class of spirits distinct from nāgas, yakṣas, etc.

Colophon

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Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.